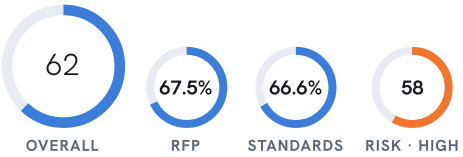
TENDER PRJ-2026-003 · AIR QUALITY AND NOISE MONITORING NETWORK

Kaltenmoor Messtechnik

Germany · Rank 2 of 3 · Report date: 25 October 2026

Not recommended



Kaltenmoor Messtechnik should not be awarded this contract: its bid fails mandatory requirements on calibration interval and references, and its service model falls short on several other requirements.

Executive summary

Kaltenmoor Messtechnik offers six air-quality stations, four Class 1 noise terminals, an on-premise AirBase platform and three years of operation and maintenance for a total bid price of USD 2,174,200 excluding VAT. The measurement and platform design is sound, with EN-referenced gas analysers, Class 1 noise terminals, 7 days of local storage and hosting on the Authority's servers. The service model is not: a full calibration every 6 months against a mandatory 3 months, an engineer on site within 5 working days, no presence in the State, and only two qualifying references. The commercial proposal is clearly priced with fixed O&M, but about 70 % of the supply value is paid before acceptance and the bank guarantees' licensing is unconfirmed. The Authority should not award to Kaltenmoor Messtechnik on this bid and should proceed with the recommended bidder, Sabkha Environmental Systems.

Technical proposal

Adequate

The measurement and data design is largely sound: EN-referenced gas analysers, Class 1 noise terminals, 7-day local storage and on-premise hosting with 10-year retention are stated plainly. The service design is where the proposal fails the RFP: full calibration every 6 months, on-site response in 5 working days and spares shipped from Oldenburg. Two mandatory requirements are not met, and the vendor's own compliance matrix marks clauses 3.4, 5.2 and 6.1 as Comply although its detail contradicts them. Several solution points also fall short, including IP54 shelters, 15-minute alarm checks by e-mail only and an Arabic dashboard offered only on request.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Platform installed on the Authority's servers in its data centre, with 10-year retention of raw and validated data and Active Directory sign-in through LDAP. REQ-011 · REQ-012 · REQ-017 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ Gas analysers named to EN 14211, EN 14212 and EN 14625, and PM analysers stated as TÜV-certified equivalent to EN 16450. REQ-006 · EM-02 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ AK-Sound 61 noise terminals stated as Class 1 to IEC 61672-1, with all-weather microphone kit, 1/3-octave spectra and exceedance audio recording, verified yearly. REQ-007 · EM-07 · Technical proposal p. 2–3
- ✓ Stations hold 7 days of data locally with automatic back-fill, and the 4G router switches automatically to a second operator. REQ-009 · EM-09 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ 24-month warranty from acceptance on all equipment and software. REQ-021 · EM-12 · Technical proposal p. 3

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ A full multipoint calibration is offered every 6 months, against a mandatory interval of at least every 3 months; the biweekly zero and span checks are not full calibrations. REQ-019 · EM-04 · Technical proposal p. 3
- ✗ On-site response is 5 working days against 48 hours, spares are shipped from Oldenburg, and there is no office or authorised service partner in the State. REQ-020 · EM-11 · REQ-025 · Technical proposal p. 2–3
- ✗ Only two references (Lower Elbe, Rhine-Ruhr) meet the 4-station threshold; the Baltic Sea Ferry Terminal has 3 stations, and no client contacts are given. REQ-024 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✗ Shelters are rated IP54, one level below the required IP55, although the matrix claims Comply. REQ-008 · EM-08 · Technical proposal p. 2, p. 4
- ✗ Alarm checks run every 15 minutes, so an exceedance can go unflagged for up to 15 minutes, and SMS alerts are not offered. REQ-014 · EM-06 · Technical proposal p. 2

Commercial proposal

Adequate

Supply and installation of USD 1,580,200 is shown separately from three years of O&M at a fixed USD 198,000 per year, all in USD excluding VAT, and the warranty is included in the supply prices. The total is below Sabkha's USD 2,446,848 and within a plausible range for the scope, though well above Nimbrel's USD 552,600. Payment is weak for the Authority: 20 % advance, 50 % on shipment and only 30 % on acceptance, so most of the supply value is paid before the trial run. The bid and performance guarantees are issued by Al-Noor National Bank on the instruction of Weser Handelsbank AG, with no statement that the issuing bank is licensed in the State. The offer states no deviations, which does not square with the technical deviations on calibration, shelters and response times.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Supply and 3-year O&M priced separately and reconciling to the total bid price, with O&M fixed at USD 198,000 per year and invoiced yearly in arrears. REQ-027 · REQ-028 · Commercial proposal p. 1–2
- ✓ Warranty of 24 months from acceptance is included in the supply prices, and O&M includes travel, calibration gases and consumables. REQ-021 · Commercial proposal p. 1, notes 1–2
- ✓ Bid validity of 120 days from the bid closing date, and the advance is capped at 20 % with an advance-payment guarantee. REQ-031 · REQ-029 · Commercial proposal p. 2

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ About 70 % of the supply value is paid before acceptance, and shipment payment falls before installation and the 30-day trial run. REQ-029 · Commercial proposal p. 2
- ✗ Bid security of USD 25,000 and performance security of 10 % are issued through a bank whose licence in the State is not stated. REQ-030 · REQ-032 · Commercial proposal p. 2
- ✗ The statement of no deviations conflicts with the technical proposal, which offers a 6-month calibration, IP54 shelters and a 5-working-day response. Commercial proposal p. 2 · Technical proposal p. 4

- Installation and commissioning at USD 175,000 includes civil works by a local subcontractor who is not named or priced separately.
  Commercial proposal p. 1, line 4 · Technical proposal p. 2

Technical vs commercial balance

Technical proposal: Adequate | Commercial proposal: Adequate

The technical proposal is the weaker side of this bid: the measurement and data design is sound, but the calibration, response and reference failures sit in the mandatory core of the service the Authority is buying. The commercial proposal is clearer than the technical service model, but the price advantage shrinks once shelters, calibration and response are brought up to the RFP, and the payment profile moves risk onto the Authority.

Value for money: At USD 2,174,200 the Authority receives six stations, four terminals, a perpetual platform licence and three years of O&M, but the fixed USD 594,000 O&M buys a service that misses the calibration and response requirements. The same money would buy more value from a bid that meets them.

Key concerns for the client

1. **Measurement drift goes undetected.** A full calibration every 6 months lets analysers run for up to half a year between full checks, so PM and gas data could drift without detection and the monthly and annual permit reports would rest on unverified data.
2. **Slow repair and data gaps.** An engineer on site within 5 working days, with spares shipped from Germany, puts the 90 % valid hourly data target at risk and could leave Al-Sahil and boundary stations down for about a week at a time.
3. **Payment ahead of performance.** With 70 % of supply value paid before acceptance and guarantee licensing unconfirmed, the Authority would have limited recourse if the system fails the trial run or the vendor defaults.
4. **Late start and delayed alarms.** Acceptance in month 8 leaves the port on portable samplers and quarterly noise surveys for longer, and exceedances may reach the HSE duty officer up to 15 minutes late.

Consultant's recommendation

The Authority should not award to Kaltenmoor Messtechnik on this bid. Mandatory requirements on calibration interval and references are not met, and a bid cannot normally be corrected after closing without changing it. The service model also fails on response, in-State presence, shelters and alarms, and the vendor's compliance matrix overstates its compliance. The Tender Committee should proceed with the recommended bidder, Sabkha Environmental Systems, and record the basis of its decision in the minutes.

CONDITIONS BEFORE AWARD

1. Three qualifying references with client contacts, verified by the Authority, if the committee reconsiders the bid.
2. Full calibration at least every 3 months, written into the O&M scope and price.
3. IP55 or better shelters for all six air-quality stations, confirmed in writing.
4. On-site response within 48 hours and spare analysers kept in the State, through a named in-State service partner under a signed agreement.
5. Alarms evaluated at the end of each averaging period and delivered by SMS and e-mail within 5 minutes, demonstrated in the trial run.

NEGOTIATION POINTS

1. Hold back at least 20 % of the supply price until acceptance, and tie the shipment payment to delivery documents.
2. Commit to all stations and terminals in operation within 6 months of signature, with delay damages per week.
3. Confirm in writing that the guarantee-issuing bank is licensed in the State, or replace the guarantees with ones from a licensed bank.
4. Withdraw the no-deviations statement and list every deviation from the tender conditions.
5. Offer training for 6 HSE staff in Arabic and English, and state whether trainee travel is included.

CLARIFICATIONS TO REQUEST

1. EN 16450 certificates for each offered PM model, and evidence that TÜV is an accredited body for this purpose.
2. Station list allocating AQ-1 to AQ-6 and terminal locations for N-1 to N-4.
3. Name of the civil works subcontractor and its share of the USD 175,000 installation line.
4. Names of the range, rate-of-change and flat-line checks used in automatic validation.
5. Client contacts for the Baltic Sea Ferry Terminal, and whether any other reference meets the 4-station threshold.

Prepared by Mizan with Claude Haiku 5.5, acting as a procurement consultant, from the RFP, the vendor's proposal and Mizan's evaluation. Scores are computed by Mizan's scoring rules. AI-generated: verify key facts against the source documents before deciding.